

Exploring Engineering Day



Engineers make our world a better place to live!

Dear Parents/Guardians/Teachers:

The School of Engineering at Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute (R.P.I.) invites parents and their children in grades 3 to 6 to attend **Exploring Engineering Day (EED)**, a **FREE** half-day program to introduce families to the field of engineering and the exciting work that engineers do to make our lives easier, safer, healthier, and fun! After a short introduction, parents will attend a 30-minute panel to learn tips for motivating their children's interest in STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Math) while their children attend a 30-minute hands-on workshop. Parents will then join their children for the last 3 hands-on workshops.

Exploring Engineering Day will take place at R.P.I. in Troy, NY on Saturday, February 15, 2014. In the case of inclement weather, the program may be postponed to the following Saturday, February 22. **Families who want to participate in EED should plan to save both Saturday dates in their calendars.** Families are encouraged to register on line at: <http://swe.union.rpi.edu/EED>

Each child must be registered separately. Telephone the program director, Barbara Ruel, at 518-276-2618 if you have difficulty accessing the link. Callers must leave their first and last name and a postal address where we can mail the paper form, or they can leave their first and last name and an email address.

Registration will be open until January 17, 2014 or until the program fills. A confirmation letter will be sent to the parent/guardian by postal mail within 14 days of receipt of the signed registration form. Additionally, detailed driving directions, parking, information, and other details will be mailed to registered guests three weeks before the event date.

The program is divided into two sessions, a morning session (primarily for boys) that runs from 8:15 a.m. to 12:10 p.m. and an afternoon session (primarily for girls) that runs from 12:45 to 4:40 p.m. The content for program is the same for boys and girls. Parents who want sons and daughters to attend the program together may register their children for the morning or the afternoon session. Morning and afternoon sessions will have a minimum of one co-ed group to allow sisters and brothers or male and female friends/relatives to participate in program activities together. There's a place on the form to reference the names of children to be paired together.

Children from different families may also attend the program together and request assignment to the same group. Each parent must complete a registration form for their own child and may reference the name of a friend or relative on their child's registration form. We'll assign referenced friends/relatives to the same session group. Each session group is limited to 20 children and 20 parents. Two RPI college students will escort and chaperone each group and an additional 10 college students will lead and engage our guests in four 30-minute hands-on, interactive activities.

While we encourage parents to accompany their children to this program, we also understand that some parents work on week-ends and may not be available to accompany their child/children. Parents/Guardians must register their own children and sign the registration form providing their permission for their children to attend the program. However, a designated adult chaperone (18 years or older) may accompany the children to the program in place of the parent.

If you have questions, please write to me at ruelb@rpi.edu or call me at 518-276-2618, Monday through Friday, between 8:30 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. If I'm away from my desk, please leave me a voice message with a short message, including the best time to reach you by phone, your phone number, or your email address.

Looking forward to having you join us for **Exploring Engineering Day 2014!**

Sincerely,

Barbara A. Ruel
Program Director, Exploring Engineering Day
School of Engineering, Jonsson Engineering Center, Room 3004
Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute
110 8th Street
Troy, NY 12180-3590
518-276-2618 (voice)
ruelb@rpi.edu